THE RISE OF HUMAN-CENTRED SMART CITIES IN AFRICA

Smart city development in Africa is shifting from a technology-first to a people-first approach. As digital and physical infrastructure expand the focus is shifting toward inclusive design, socio-spatial justice, and community resilience.



Quick stats:

Urban growth: Africa's urban population to double by 2050 (UN-Habitat).

Digital access: Internet penetration rising from 33% (2022) to 50%+ (2025 projection).

Smart city initiatives: 30+ projects across Africa (Ethiopia, Rwanda, South Africa, Egypt).

Top priorities: Mobility, housing, energy, and governance.